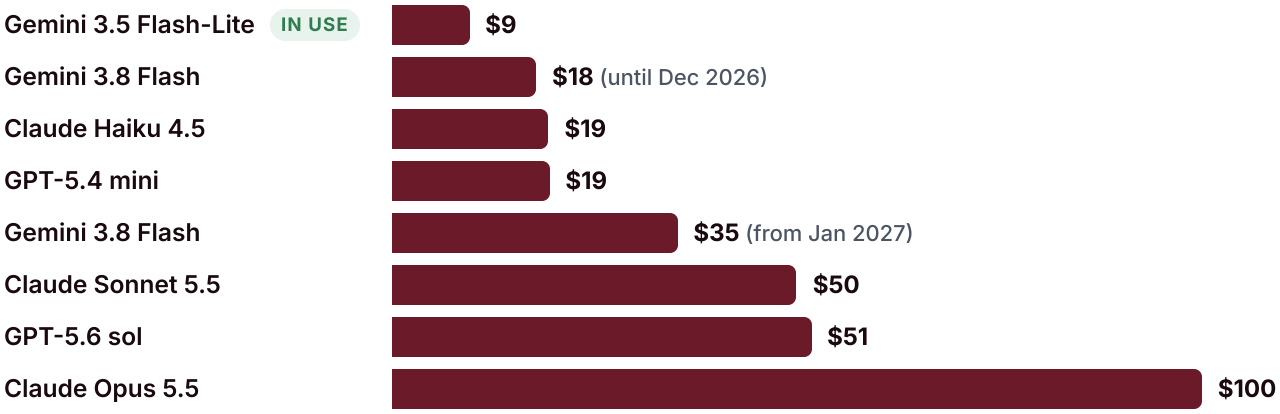
AI MODEL COMPARISON · OCTOBER 2026

Which AI should read the bills?

The system uses an AI model to read every utility bill and pull out the numbers for the report. This page compares the models from Google, Anthropic, OpenAI and DeepSeek at your expected volume of **50–70 full requests a month**.

Monthly cost at 60 full requests

Shortlisted models only. One full request reads 13 bills.



Our recommendation

BEST VALUE

Keep Gemini 3.5 Flash-Lite

About $10 a month. Already built and tested on real bills. Nothing to change.

IF YOU WANT MORE ACCURACY

Gemini 3.8 Flash

Google's newest Flash model. A simple switch plus a re-test, no rebuild. $18, then $35 a month.

IF YOU PREFER CLAUDE

Claude Sonnet 5.5

About $50 a month. Strong on tables, but the bill-reading steps must be rebuilt and re-tested.

At this volume every sensible option costs between $10 and $60 a month, about the same as the Make plan. **A single wrong number in a customer report costs more than the difference.** Before switching, we suggest running the same real test bills through the two or three finalists and comparing every figure. That test costs only a few dollars.

Why not DeepSeek. Its API doesn't accept PDF files, so every bill would need an extra conversion step. Its privacy policy says personal data is processed and stored in China, and these bills carry homeowners' names, addresses and account numbers.

Privacy. Paid Gemini, Claude and OpenAI API accounts don't use your data to train their models. Gemini's free tier does, so a paid key is required.

How the costs were estimated. About 15,000 tokens read and 3,000 written per bill, 13 bills per full request. Providers count PDF pages differently, so treat the figures as a comparison, not a quote.

ALL MODELS

Full comparison

Model	Status	Price in / out per million tokens	Per full request	50–70 a month	Verdict
GOOGLE GEMINI					
2.5 Flash-Lite	Older	$0.10 / $0.40	$0.04	$2–3	Cheapest, but likely to be retired
3.1 Flash-Lite	Older	$0.25 / $1.50	$0.11	$5–8	A generation behind
3.5 Flash-Lite	Stable · in use	$0.30 / $2.50	$0.16	**$8–11**	**Recommended:** proven on real bills
2.5 Flash	Older	$0.30 / $2.50	$0.16	$8–11	Same price as 3.5 Flash-Lite, older
3 Flash	Preview	$0.50 / $3	$0.21	$11–15	Preview, can change
3.8 Flash	Stable · newest	$0.75 / $3.75 $1.50 / $7.50 from Jan	$0.29 $0.59	**$15–20** $29–41	**Upgrade option:** easy switch
3.5 Flash	Legacy	$1.50 / $9	$0.64	$32–45	Costs more than 3.8 Flash
2.5 Pro	Older	$1.25 / $10	$0.63	$32–44	Older generation
3.1 Pro	Preview	$2 / $12	$0.86	$43–60	Most capable Gemini, still a preview
ANTHROPIC CLAUDE					
Haiku 4.5	Current	$1 / $5	$0.32	$16–22	Cheapest Claude, less careful
Sonnet 5.5	Current	$2 / $10	$0.83	**$42–58**	**Claude option:** needs rebuild
Opus 5.5	Current	$4 / $20	$1.66	$83–116	Most careful Claude, 2× Sonnet
Fable 5.1	Current	$10 / $50	$4.20+	$210–290+	Built for hard reasoning; overkill
OPENAI GPT					
GPT-5.6 luna	Current	$0.20 / $1.20	$0.09	$4–6	Very cheap; accuracy on bills unknown
GPT-5.4 mini	Current	$0.75 / $4.50	$0.32	$16–23	Mid-range, needs rebuild
GPT-5.6 sol	Current	$2 / $12	$0.86	$43–60	Same class as Sonnet 5.5
GPT-5.5	Current	$5 / $30	$2.15	$107–150	Expensive for this job
DEEPSEEK					
deepseek-flash	Current	$0.30 / $1.20 peak	$0.11	$5–7	Not suitable: see page 1
deepseek-v4-pro	Current	$1.32 / $3.96 peak	$0.41	$21–29	Not suitable: see page 1

Prices from each provider's published API price list, checked 6 October 2026: ai.google.dev/gemini-api/docs/pricing · platform.claude.com/docs/en/about-claude/pricing · developers.openai.com/api/docs/pricing · api-docs.deepseek.com/quick_start/pricing. Prices can change.